

DERRON BORDERS

KANSAS STATE UNIVERSITY

Research

My research sits at the intersection of social epistemology and adult learning, with a particular focus on how people break free from hegemonic frames—the deeply embedded worldviews shaped by ideology, power, and social belonging. I study how adults in so-called “post-truth” societies navigate—and sometimes transcend—epistemic bubbles, echo chambers, and neoliberal discourses that shape public understanding of political issues.

Keywords: adult learning, social epistemology, hegemony, critical andragogy, transformative learning

Academic Preparation

2024 – Present	 Ph.D., Adult Learning & Leadership (<i>in progress</i>) – Kansas State University
2014 – 2016	 M.A., College Student Personnel – Bowling Green State University
2010 – 2014	 M.A., Linguistics – University of Utah Thesis title: <i>The role of gender socialization and sibilants in the perception of gay- and straight-sounding voices: a study of returned Latter-day Saint missionaries in Utah</i> Committee: Mariana Di Paolo (Chair), Aaron Kaplan, Lisa Diamond
2005 – 2008	 B.A., Linguistics, Cum Laude – The Ohio State University  B.A., French, Cum Laude – The Ohio State University
2003 – 2005	 Completed 69 credit hours towards A.A. in Humanities, – Columbus State Community College

Publications

Presentations, Lectures, and Workshops

Professional Administrative Experience

«««« HEAD ===== »»»» 9e7cfce3b4ff61e247d45884b64377efd908f140 2024 – 2026	 Investigator, Office of Civil Rights and Title IX, Kansas State University
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Professional Administrative Experience (continued)

2021 – 2023	 Director, Office of Diversity and Inclusion, Samuel Curtis Johnson Graduate School of Management, Cornell University
2020 – 2021	 Assistant Director of Student Life and Academic Programming, Cornell in Washington, Brooks School of Public Policy, Cornell University
2016 – 2020	 Director, Language House, West Campus House System, Cornell University

Industry Experience

2011 – 2013	 Lead, Language Development, UnBound Games, Salt Lake City, UT
2008	 Associate Transcriber, VoiceBox Technologies, Bellevue, WA

Graduate Experience

- 2026 – Present  **Graduate Intern**, Instructional Design and Digital Learning, Center for Academic Innovation, Kansas State University
- 2014 – 2016  **Graduate Coordinator**, Ethnic Student Center, Office of Multicultural Affairs, Bowling Green State University
- 2013  **Graduate Research Associate**, National Center for Voice and Speech, University of Utah
- 2010 – 2014  **Project Manager**, Shoshoni Language Project, University of Utah
- 2010 – 2013  **Teaching Assistant**, Department of Linguistics, University of Utah

Teaching Experience

- 2010 – 2013  **Instructor of Record**, Department of Linguistics, University of Utah
- Teaching & Learning Across Languages (ESL 1600), American History for ESL (ESL 1700), Cross Cultural Communication (LING 3600), Expository Writing for ESL (ESL 1060)
- 2009 – 2010  **Auxiliar de inglés (teaching assistant)**, North American Language and Culture Assistants Program, Spain
- 9th-12th grade
- 2008 – 2009  **Assistant d'anglais (teaching assistant)**, Teaching Assistant Program in France
- K-6th grade

University, College, & Department Service

Cornell University

University Level:

- 2022-2023  Elected Member, SC Johnson College of Business Representative, Employee Assembly
- 2020-2021  Selected Member, Building Bridges - Diverse Talent Recruitment and Retention Task Force

College Level:

- 2021-2023  Chair, Measurement and Accountability Committee, Dean's Leadership Council on Combatting Racism and Promoting Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Belonging, SC Johnson College of Business

Department Level:

- 2022-2023  Chair, Johnson Anti-Racism Initiative, SC Johnson Graduate School of Management
- 2020-2021  Chair, Cornell in Washington DEI Strategic Planning Committee, Cornell in Washington

Bowling Green State University

University Level:

-  Graduate Diversity and Belonging Representative, Graduate Student Senate

University of Utah

Department Level:

- 2012  Organizing Chair, University of Utah Student Conference in Linguistics
- 2011-2012  Chair, Graduate Student Advisory Committee in Linguistics, Department of Linguistics

University, College, & Department Service (continued)

-  Selected Member, Organizing Committee for the Annual Conference on Endangered Languages and Cultures of Native America, Center for American Indian Languages

National Service

Professional Membership

- 2024 – Present  American Association For Adult and Continuing Education
- 2015 – 2023  ACPA - College Student Educators International
- 2022 – 2023  National Association of Diversity Officers in Higher Education
- 2015 – 2017  NASPA - Student Affairs Administrators in Higher Education
- 2012 – 2015  American Dialect Society
-  International Gender and Language Association
- 2011 – 2013  American Anthropological Association
- 2010 – 2015  Linguistics Society of America

Leadership

- 2022-2023  **Chair, Membership and Outreach**, Indigenous Student Affairs Network, ACPA - College Student Educators International
- 2016-2022  **Chair, Marketing and Communications**, Indigenous Student Affairs Network, ACPA - College Student Educators International
- 2020  **Founder**, Coalition for Fat Identities, ACPA - College Student Educators International

Committee Work

- 2018-2022  Annual Conference Proposals Review Committee, ACPA - College Student Educators International

Awards & Honors

- 2013, 2014  Fellowship, Western American Language Research Group, University of Utah
- 2013  Salt Lake City Weekly Best of Utah Award, The Shoshoni Language Project Team
-  National Indian Education Association's William G. Demmert Cultural Freedom Award, The Shoshoni Language Project Team

Skills & Knowledge

- Administrative  budgeting & bookkeeping, program and event coordination, project management, recruiting
- Editorial  academic copyediting, proofreading, scholarly writing, manuscript preparation, peer review process, APA style (7th ed.), Chicago style (18th ed.), citation & reference management, style guide adherence
- Interpersonal  academic advising, career coaching, conflict resolution, crisis management, training development and facilitation, mediation
- Policy  Affirmative Action, Americans with Disabilities Act, Clery Act, Equal Opportunity Employment, FERPA, Title VI, Title VII, Title IX, VAWA
- Specializations  access & disability, allyship, cross-cultural communication, decolonization, emotional intelligence, fat liberation, gender & sexuality, Indigenous issues, implicit bias, inclusive leadership

Skills & Knowledge (continued)

Strategic		data analytics and assessment, risk analysis, strategic planning
Technical		Adobe Creative Suite, Asana, Audacity, Canva, Canvas, CSS, FileMaker Pro, GitHub, Google Applications, HandShake, HTML, JavaScript, Jekyll, L ^A T _E X, Maxient, Microsoft 365, Notion, NVivo, Obsidian, PeopleSoft, Praat, Python, Qualtrics, R, Rise 360, Salesforce, social media management, Synthesia.io, Visual Studio Code, Zotero

Language Knowledge

Languages		English	● ● ● ● ●	<i>native</i>
		French	● ● ● ● ●	<i>fluent</i>
		Spanish	● ● ● ● ●	<i>fluent</i>
		Catalan	● ● ● ● ●	<i>advanced</i>
		Dutch	● ● ● ● ●	<i>intermediate</i>
		German	● ● ● ● ●	<i>intermediate</i>
		Finnish	● ● ● ● ●	<i>beginner</i>
		Romanian	● ● ● ● ●	<i>beginner</i>
		Arabic	● ● ● ● ●	<i>beginner</i>
		Shoshoni	● ● ● ● ●	<i>field knowledge</i>